

INTERRUPT - The 12 Scroll Interrupters

Stop the Scroll in 0.8 Seconds - The One-Pager

Every viral hook does one of three things to the brain: breaks reality · shouts louder than the feed · opens a loop it must close

The 12 categories below cover all three. Learn these, and you'll never stare at a blank prompt again.

THE 12 CATEGORIES (and the one-liner you can use)

| Category | The Interrupt | One-Liner

- | # | Category | The Interrupt | One-Liner |
|----|---------------------------------|--|---|
| 1 | Gravity & Physics | Float, fall, rise, zero-G, ground opens | "The brain assumes gravity. Break it." |
| 2 | Scale & Proportion | Giant, shrink/grow, extreme zoom, miniature | "Scale is relative - exaggerate the reference." |
| 3 | Time Manipulation | Freeze, reverse, slow-mo, time-lapse, loop | "You control the viewer's clock." |
| 4 | Glitch & Corruption | Glitch, pixel dissolve, VHS, melt, data-mosh | "Broken is an attention signal." |
| 5 | Material & Texture | Sand, water, smoke, paper, glass, clay | "What is it made of? Change that." |
| 6 | Mirror & Symmetry | Infinite mirror, reflection mismatch, kaleidoscope | "The reflection is the self. Violate it." |
| 7 | Impossible Objects | Door/portal, out-of-place, Escher, living objects | "Juxtaposition is the hook." |
| 8 | Body & Anatomy | Extra limbs, head swap, elastic, detached parts | "The human form is the strongest hook." |
| 9 | Camera & Perspective | Whip-pan, dutch angle, dolly zoom, fourth wall | "The camera is an invisible character." |
| 10 | Emotion Subversion | Bait & switch, mask crack, unexpected reaction | "Prediction-error is the hook." |
| 11 | Light & Color | Selective color, neon, silhouette, inversion | "Contrast is a signal." |
| 12 | Typography & Text | Kinetic slam, shatter, text-in-world, morph | "Text is a visual, not just a message." |

THE 3-PART FORMULA (the only rule you need)

Every scroll interrupter works because it follows:

Pattern Interrupt (0-0.8s) → Identity Signal (0.8-1.5s) → Open Loop (1.5-3s)

1. Interrupt - break reality or shout, instantly.
2. Identity - make the viewer feel "this is about me."
3. Open loop - leave an unanswered question so they stay.

THE AI PROMPT FORMULA (6 parts)

1. **CAMERA & FRAME** - locked camera, 9:16 vertical, no unwanted motion
2. **SUBJECT & ACTION** - who/what, doing what
3. **EFFECT / MECHANISM** - the named interrupt, as physical behavior
4. **ENVIRONMENT** - background, light, mood
5. **STYLE / MEDIUM** - photoreal / 3D / paper / clay / VHS
6. **NEGATIVE PROMPT** - the failure modes to exclude

The golden rule: state the interrupt as a *verb + direction*, not a vibe. Write "the water flows upward into the glass" - never "surreal water."

THE 20-SECOND NEGATIVE PROMPT (save this)

frozen limbs, rigid pose, standing, walking normally, floating upright, normal physics, ground contact, strings, wires, visible hands, extra limbs, distorted anatomy, wrong number of fingers, blurry subject, jump cuts, broken motion, hard cuts, camera shake, text, watermark, logo, play button

START HERE - Which Interrupt Should I Use?

Before choosing a prompt, choose the job the opening needs to do. The technique is the mechanism. The emotion and content objective determine which mechanism is appropriate.

Your goal | Start with | Why

---|---|---

****Awe / wonder**** | Gravity & Physics, Scale & Proportion | Breaks physical expectations immediately

****Curiosity / mystery**** | Impossible Objects, Mirror & Symmetry, Time Manipulation | Creates an unanswered visual question

****Unease / uncanny**** | Mirror & Symmetry, Body & Anatomy, Emotion Subversion | Violates a familiar human expectation

****Energy / intensity**** | Camera & Perspective, Glitch & Corruption | Creates movement or visual instability

****Premium / aesthetic**** | Material & Texture, Light & Color | Makes the visual itself the attraction

****Mute-first communication**** | Typography & Text, Light & Color | Carries meaning visually without relying on audio

****Teaching / demonstration**** | Time Manipulation, Scale & Proportion, Typography & Text | Makes a concept visible quickly

****Story / reveal**** | Emotion Subversion, Impossible Objects, Time Manipulation | Opens a narrative question

****Product / brand attention**** | Light & Color, Material & Texture, Scale & Proportion | Keeps the product central while breaking expectation

The three-question shortcut

1. What should the viewer feel? Awe, curiosity, unease, energy, delight, or recognition? 2. What must the viewer understand without sound? If yes, favor visually legible mechanisms such as text, contrast, scale, or physical transformation. 3. What is the content asking the viewer to do next? Watch a reveal, learn something, feel something, or consider a product?

Choose one primary interrupt. Add a second technique only when it strengthens the first.

The attention sequence

0.0-0.8s: INTERRUPT - break expectation or create a strong salience spike.

0.8-1.5s: IDENTITY - make the viewer understand why this matters to them.

1.5-3.0s: OPEN LOOP - create a question, tension, promise, or unresolved transformation that rewards continued viewing.

WHICH ONE DO I USE TODAY?

Ask yourself three questions:

1. What should the viewer FEEL? (awe → gravity/scale · unease → mirror/body · energy → camera/glitch)
2. Does it need to work on mute? (if yes → typography/text) 3. Am I selling, teaching, or storytelling? (selling → light/color · teaching → time/scale · storytelling → emotion/impossible)

The interrupt serves the emotion. Not the other way around.

Want the full library? Each of the 12 categories has a deep-dive guide with 15-25 ready-to-paste AI prompts, a negative-prompt cheat sheet, and the psychology behind every technique.